

Wildlife & Biodiversity

Andhra Deputy CM Pawan Kalyan launches ambitious Project HANUMAN to tackle human-wildlife conflict

'HANUMAN' is an acronym for 'Healing and Nurturing Units for Monitoring, Aid and Nursing of Wildlife'



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On World Wildlife Day 2026, Andhra Pradesh Deputy Chief Minister Pawan Kalyan launched Project HANUMAN to tackle the growing problem of human-wildlife conflict in the state.

The project was unveiled at the Andhra Pradesh Special Police (APSP) 6th Battalion Parade Grounds in the town of Mangalagiri, Guntur district.

‘HANUMAN’ is an acronym for ‘Healing and Nurturing Units for Monitoring, Aid and Nursing of Wildlife’.

“Wildlife is essential for ecological balance, biodiversity, and climate stability. Protecting habitats ensures harmony between humans and nature and secures a sustainable future. Today, the Andhra Pradesh Government, under the Environment and Forest Ministry, inaugurated the HANUMAN Project (Healing and Nurturing Units for Monitoring, Aid and Nursing of Wildlife), a dedicated initiative to rescue, treat, rehabilitate, and monitor injured wildlife, strengthening conservation and rapid response systems across the state. On this World Wildlife Day, let us unite to conserve habitats, prevent exploitation, and safeguard our natural heritage for generations to come,” Kalyan stated in a post on the microblogging site, X.

What the project entails

The problem of human-wildlife conflict has increased in Andhra Pradesh in recent years. In the fiscal year 2025-2026, 2,107 cases of such conflict were recorded across the state and almost Rs 4 crore was paid as compensation to affected persons and families, according to a social media post by the deputy chief minister’s office on *Facebook*.



Facebook post added. Compensation for livestock killed will be according to market value.

The government, through the state forest department, has also initiated the creation of village-level 'Vajra' (Wildlife Rakshak) teams. These trained local volunteers will handle snake rescues and minor wildlife incursions within villages, reducing dependence on distant officials and curbing panic-driven reactions that often aggravate conflict, according to a report by [SouthFirst](#).

Under Project HANUMAN, the government will provide 100 vehicles—93 Rapid Response and seven ambulances—to provide care and medical assistance to wildlife. Each vehicle will have a team consisting of a forest range officer, veterinary staff, tribal helpers and para veterans.

Four wildlife rescue and treatment centres have also been established in Visakhapatnam, Rajamahendravaram, Tirupati and Birlut.

The state will also address the depredations of wild elephants which has been getting serious in Chittoor, Srikakulam and Parvatipuram Manyam districts. "To solve this problem, with the cooperation of the Karnataka Government, we have brought four *Kumki* elephants and completed 8 operations successfully so far and provided protection to the people and crops from the elephants," the statement on *Facebook* noted.

Artificial intelligence will be used to monitor wildlife movements. The authorities are developing a system to provide advance warnings before animals enter forest boundary areas. A Hanuman digital app has also been developed by the forest department.

"The Hanuman Project is a comprehensive technical and scientific program designed to prevent and reduce the conflict between human-wildlife. Through this project, we are going to further the protection and security of people in villages bordering forests as well as conservation of wildlife," said Kalyan.

The Panchayati Raj and forest departments will coordinate with other departments like agriculture, horticulture, revenue and police for Project HANUMAN, he added.

Project HANUMAN

 insightsonindia.com/2026/03/05/project-hanuman

Source: [DTE](#)

Subject: *Environment*

Context: The Government of Andhra Pradesh launched Project HANUMAN on World Wildlife Day 2026 to address the rising [human–wildlife conflict](#) in the state.



About [Project HANUMAN](#):

What it is?

- Project HANUMAN stands for Healing and Nurturing Units for Monitoring, Aid and Nursing of Wildlife.

- It is a state-level wildlife protection and conflict mitigation initiative aimed at rescuing, treating, rehabilitating, and monitoring wildlife while [protecting communities](#) near forests.

State: Andhra Pradesh

Aim:

- To reduce human–wildlife conflict and ensure coexistence between local communities and wildlife.
- To improve rapid response, wildlife rescue operations, and scientific monitoring of animal movement.

Key Features:

1. **Rapid Response Infrastructure** – Deployment of 100 vehicles (93 rapid response units and 7 wildlife ambulances) for quick rescue and medical aid.
2. **Wildlife Rescue Centres** – Establishment of four rescue and treatment centres in Visakhapatnam, Rajamahendravaram, Tirupati, and Birlut.
3. **Village-level Volunteer Teams** – Creation of ‘Vajra’ (Wildlife Rakshak) teams to handle snake rescues and minor wildlife incidents in villages.
4. **AI-based Monitoring** – Use of Artificial Intelligence systems to track wildlife movement and provide early warnings when animals approach [human settlements](#).
5. **HANUMAN Digital App** – A digital platform for wildlife monitoring, reporting conflicts, and coordination with authorities.
6. **Compensation Support** – Increase in compensation for wildlife attacks: ₹10 lakh for death and ₹2 lakh for injuries, with livestock compensation based on market value.
7. **Use of Kumki Elephants** – Deployment of trained elephants to manage and drive away wild elephant herds in conflict-prone districts.
8. **Inter-departmental Coordination** – Collaboration between forest, police, agriculture, revenue, horticulture, and Panchayati Raj departments.

Significance

- **Human safety:** Protects communities living near forests from [wildlife attacks](#).
- **Wildlife conservation:** Ensures safe rescue, treatment, and rehabilitation of injured animals.

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‘Hanuman’ project launched to tackle human–wildlife conflict in Andhra Pradesh

The project — Healing and Nurturing Units for Monitoring, Aid and Nursing of Wildlife (HANUMAN) — has been designed as a comprehensive scientific and technological intervention to protect both wildlife and people living in forest fringe villages

Updated - March 03, 2026 10:47 pm IST - VIJAYAWADA



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Deputy Chief Minister Pawan Kalyan at the inauguration of the Hanuman Foundation in Amravati on Tuesday. | Photo Credit: ANI

In a major initiative aimed at reducing human–wildlife conflict and strengthening wildlife conservation, Andhra Pradesh Deputy Chief Minister and Minister for Forest & Environment Pawan Kalyan on Tuesday (March 3, 2026) launched the ‘Hanuman’ Project in Mangalagiri near Vijayawada.

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The project — Healing and Nurturing Units for Monitoring, Aid and Nursing of Wildlife (HANUMAN) — has been designed as a comprehensive scientific and technological intervention to protect both wildlife and people living in forest fringe villages. Addressing the gathering, Mr. Pawan Kalyan said India believes in the philosophy of “Vasudhaika Kutumbam,” where all living beings, including wildlife, are part of one family. Maintaining ecological balance and protecting wildlife are essential for human survival, he noted.



Also Read: Man-animal conflict frays India's wildlife conservation ethos



As part of the launch, over 100 specially designed rapid response and rescue vehicles were flagged off. Of these, 93 are Rapid Response and Rescue Vehicles, while seven are fully equipped ambulances to provide medical aid to injured wild animals. The system also includes four Wildlife Rescue and Treatment Centres at Visakhapatnam, Rajamahendravaram, Tirupati, and Byrluti, along with 19 rapid response teams stationed across the State.

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Also Read: Human-elephant conflict in Chittoor district shows sign of abatement



Each vehicle will be staffed with a Forest Range Officer, veterinary personnel, tribal helpers, and para-veterinarians to ensure swift and professional handling of wildlife emergencies. At the village level, 'Vajra' teams — trained wildlife protectors — are being formed and equipped with rescue kits to handle incidents involving snakes and other animals locally.

Highlighting compensation measures, Mr. Pawan Kalyan said the ex gratia amount for deaths due to wild animal attacks has been increased from ₹5 lakh to ₹10 lakh,

while compensation for injuries has been raised to ₹2 lakh. In 2025–26 alone, 2,107 cases of human–wildlife conflict were recorded across the State, with nearly ₹4 crore paid as compensation. Livestock losses are being compensated based on market value.

Also Read: UDF will find a permanent solution to the increasing human-animal conflict, says V.D. Satheesan



The Minister also pointed out that in districts like Chittoor, Srikakulam, and Parvathipuram Manyam, elephant-related incidents have been significant. With support from the Karnataka government, four ‘Kumki’ elephants were brought in, and eight operations have been successfully conducted to drive away wild elephants and protect crops and lives.

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Artificial Intelligence (AI)-based monitoring systems are being piloted to track wildlife movement and provide early warnings in forest-border villages. A dedicated Hanuman digital app and GPS tracking system have also been launched to ensure real-time coordination.

During the event, the Deputy Chief Minister distributed appreciation certificates to outstanding Forest personnel and NGOs contributing to wildlife conservation. He also inspected special galleries showcasing rescue equipment, wildlife conservation measures, medicinal plants, and information on species such as the King Cobra found in the Eastern Ghats.

Also Read: Forest Minister attributes human-animal conflicts to increase in animal population





Senior officials present at the event included Forest, Environment and Science & Technology Principal Secretary Kantilaal Dande, Principal Chief Conservator of Forests and Head of Forest Force P. V. Chalapathi Rao, Forest Department Advisor P. Mallikarjuna Rao, IT Advisor P. Nageswara Rao, Additional PCCF Rahul Pandey, Guntur District Collector Tamim Ansaria, and APSP 6th Battalion Commandant Nagesh Babu, among others.

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